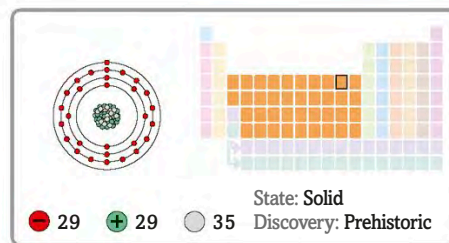


29
Cu

Copper



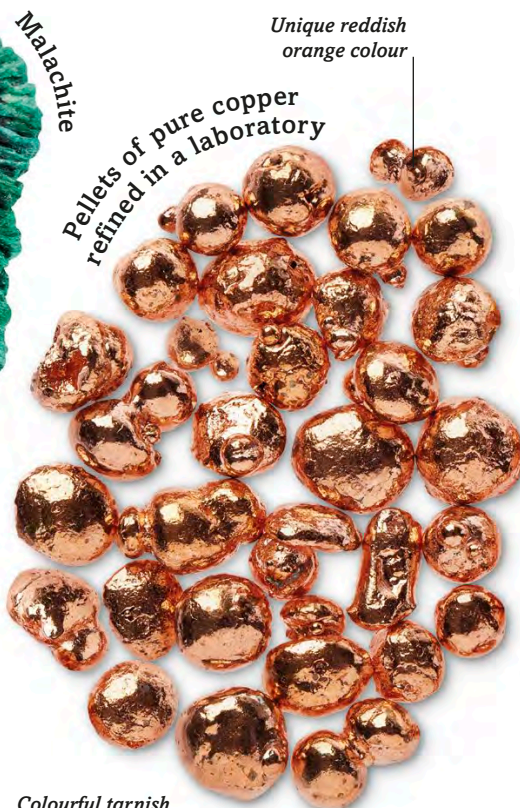
Forms



Branchlike crystals of copper

In caves, feather-like crystals are often formed.

These golden yellow crystals contain copper sulfide.



Chalcopyrite

Colourful tarnish develops when the mineral reacts with air.



Crustacean blood



Crustacean blood is blue because it contains copper.

Copper is a soft, bendy metal that is an excellent conductor of electricity and heat. Although it is one of the few elements found pure in nature, most of it exists in ores such as **chalcopyrite**. Other copper minerals, such as **malachite** and **azurite**, are brightly coloured.

Copper is the only metal that has a reddish colour in its pure form. **Pure copper** is mainly used as **wires** in electrical equipment. Copper wire wrapped around an iron core and then electrified helps create an **electromagnet**. Because they can be switched on or off, electromagnets can